

Toward a Theoretical Framework for Multimodal IP Design with ICH Symbols: The Case of Southeastern Chongqing Earthenware

Mengqi Fang¹, Lei Su^{2*}

¹Sichuan Fine Arts Institute, Chongqing 400053, China

²Chongqing Normal University, Chongqing 401331, China

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Abstract: This study examines earthenware from southeastern Chongqing to develop a theoretical framework for integrating intangible cultural heritage (ICH) symbols into multimodal IP design. Grounded in semiotics and visual communication theory, it analyzes the roles of ICH symbols in brand-oriented IP design and the pathways for their innovative application. Based on a systematic literature review, the paper articulates a three-part framework—symbol extraction, visual translation, and multimodal dissemination—and applies it to a case analysis of the pottery’s form language, color composition, and cultural connotations. The findings indicate that ICH symbols embody substantial cultural value and aesthetic features; semiotic decoding enables the distillation of core elements, visual communication methods support modern reinterpretation and image reconstruction, and multimodal dissemination broadens application contexts and impact. The framework promotes the creative transformation and innovative development of ICH and offers theoretical guidance and practical pathways for regional branding and national image building.

Keywords: intangible cultural heritage (ICH) symbols; multimodal IP design; semiotics; visual communication; southeastern Chongqing earthenware

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1. Introduction

Intangible cultural heritage (ICH) constitutes vital cultura symbols that carry regional historical memory and spiritual values. Amid the rise of the “Guochao” (China-chic) trend and growing cultural confidence, integrating ICH symbols into brand-oriented IP design not only supports the creative transmission of tradition but also contributes to place branding and national image building. Through systematic planning and visual articulation, IP design turns cultural themes into recognizable identities that can circulate across media; a multimodal IP approach further spans visual, auditory, and narrative channels to achieve holistic shaping and amplify communicative impact. In recent years, practical efforts to develop ICH into IP have proliferated, yet theoretical research remains insufficient^[1]. Using earthenware from southeastern Chongqing as a case, this paper constructs a framework of “symbol extraction–visual translation–multimodal dissemination,” analyzes its formal language, color scheme, and cultural connotations, and summarizes pathways and theoretical models for the modern transformation of ICH symbols, offering methodological and practical references for

面向非物质文化遗产符号的多模态IP设计理论框架：以渝东南土陶为例

方梦琪¹, 苏磊^{2*1}四川美术学院，重庆 400053，中国²重庆师范大学，重庆 401331，中国**版权：**© 2025 作者。这是一篇根据知识共享署名许可协议（CC BY 4.0）条款提供的开放获取文章，允许在任何媒介上分发和复制，前提是引用原始作品。

摘要：本研究以渝东南土陶为对象，构建了将非物质文化遗产（非遗）符号融入多模态IP设计的理论框架。基于符号学与视觉传播理论，分析了非遗符号在品牌化IP设计中的作用及其创新应用路径。通过系统文献综述，提出了符号提取、视觉转译与多模态传播的三部分框架，并将其应用于陶器造型语言、色彩构成及文化内涵的案例分​​析。结果表明，非遗符号蕴含丰富的文化价值与审美特征；符号解码有助于提炼核心元素，视觉传播方法支持现代诠释与形象重构，多模态传播拓展了应用场景与影响力。该框架促进了非遗的创造性转化与创新性发展，并为地域品牌建设与国家形象塑造提供了理论指导与实践路径。

关键词：非物质文化遗产（ICH）符号；多模态IP设计；符号学；视觉传播；渝东南土陶

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1. 引言

非物质文化遗产（ICH）构成了承载区域历史记忆和精神价值的重要文化符号。在“国潮”趋势兴起和文化自信日益增强的背景下，将非遗符号融入品牌化IP设计，不仅有助于传统文化的创造性传承，也为地方品牌化和国家形象塑造做出贡献。通过系统化规划和视觉呈现，IP设计将文化主题转化为可识别的身份标识，能够在不同媒介中传播；而多模态IP方法进一步跨越视觉、听觉和叙事渠道，实现整体塑造并增强传播效果。近年来，将非遗开发为IP的实践尝试日益增多，但理论研究仍显不足^[1]。本文以渝东南土陶为例，构建“符号提取—视觉转译—多模态传播”的框架，分析其形式语言、色彩方案及文化内涵，总结非遗符号现代转化的路径与理论模型，为

ICH-oriented IP design.

2. Literature Review

As the integration of intangible cultural heritage (ICH) with the cultural-creative sector deepens, an increasing body of research focuses on how to transform traditional cultural symbols into modern IP forms. On the one hand, practical explorations show that ICH symbols can empower brands and yield distinctive cultural IPs. For example, People’s Daily has noted that early development often remained at the level of simple pattern extraction and replication, whereas current practice emphasizes deeper cultural expression and multi-dimensional innovation pathways. Typical cases include incorporating ICH elements such as Beijing-Opera facial makeup and auspicious cloud motifs into automobile exteriors to create “Peking-Opera IP editions,” indicating that ICH symbols are breaking through traditional boundaries toward fashionable, youth-oriented, and everyday expressions. On the other hand, the academy has begun to synthesize experience with the IP-ization of ICH symbols. Taking Nantong blue calico as an example, Yin Yue and others examine the innovative integration of ICH elements into IP character design, analyzing how patterns and colors are embedded in costumes and accessories and demonstrating market potential through derivative IP products (Liu et al., 2024)^[2]. Studies suggest that traditional craft patterns can be implanted as visual symbols in IP imagery to confer cultural connotation and recognizability, thereby achieving the modern transformation and value enhancement of ICH. In addition, some scholars focus on the IP-ization of minority legends: Liu Ning and Sun Yujun, adopting a semiotic-semantics approach, distilled cultural symbols from the Mulao legend of the White Horse Goddess into a symbol library for IP design and, using Panofsky’s three-level iconological analysis, explored new avenues for translating minority mythic symbols into IP imagery. Collectively, this literature indicates that extracting archetypal imagery from ICH symbols and recombining it through semiotic analysis and contemporary design methods constitutes the main pathway in current ICH-oriented IP design. However, most existing studies remain case-driven, with insufficient discussion of underlying theoretical frameworks—especially a lack of systematic research on multimodal dissemination.

Design Theory Foundations from Semiotics and Visual Communication. Semiotic theory provides an essential framework for understanding and designing cultural symbols. Saussure’s classic signifier–signified model posits that a sign consists of an external form (signifier) and an internal meaning (signified), whose union constitutes the sign’s full meaning^[3]. In design practice, the extraction and application of symbols amount to a process in which designers select, organize, and translate visual elements so that audiences can clearly grasp the intended information and affect. Cassirer famously argued that “man is a symbolic animal,” and that cultural creation and transmission rely on symbolic thinking^[4]. Accordingly, traditional cultural patterns and totems, sedimented over time, have become symbols that carry specific connotations. Visual communication focuses on conveying meaning and aesthetic value through visual sign systems; in the modern rearticulation of ICH symbols, designers must balance “form” and “meaning,” that is, outward formal beauty and inward cultural implication. Recent studies propose concrete methodologies for symbolic translation: Zhang Yuting et al. (2024) argue that innovation in traditional pattern design can proceed from three angles—extraction of constituent elements, articulation of value connotations, and innovation in design applications—thereby enabling the transformation of traditional symbolic patterns into contemporary design. This entails, first, analyzing the basic elements and formal principles of traditional symbols; second, excavating and expressing their cultural values in design; and third, integrating new media and application scenarios to revitalize traditional symbols with contemporary vitality and industrial value^[5]. Research by Yu Guitao and colleagues on the cultural genes of Qianjiang earthenware likewise shows that cultural-creative design can adopt techniques such as reduction and generalization, realistic simplification, and exaggerated emphasis to artistically process traditional vessel features, creating elements that are both ethnically distinctive and fashion-forward. In sum, semiotics offers theoretical support for extracting and interpreting traditional symbols, while visual communication provides methodological support for symbolic reconstruction and aesthetic presentation. Combining the two enables a theoretical framework to guide ICH-symbol IP design that remains faithful to cultural connotations while meeting

面向非物质文化遗产的IP设计。

2. 文献综述

随着非物质文化遗产（非遗）与文创产业融合的深化，越来越多的研究聚焦于如何将传统文化符号转化为现代IP形式。一方面，实践探索表明，非遗符号能够赋能品牌并产生独特的文化IP。例如，人民日报指出，早期开发往往停留在简单的图案提取和复刻层面，而当前实践更强调深层次的文化表达与多维创新路径。典型案例包括将京剧脸谱、祥云纹样等非遗元素融入汽车外观，打造“京剧IP版”，这表明非遗符号正在突破传统边界，向时尚化、年轻化、日常化表达迈进。另一方面，学术界开始系统总结非遗符号IP化的经验。以南通蓝印花布为例，尹月等人考察了非遗元素在IP角色设计中的创新整合，分析图案与色彩如何嵌入服装与配饰，并通过衍生IP产品展示市场潜力（刘等，2024）^[2]。研究表明，传统工艺图案可植入作为视觉符号于IP形象中，赋予文化内涵与辨识度，从而实现非遗的现代转化与价值提升。此外，部分学者聚焦少数民族传说的IP化：刘宁和孙玉军采用符号学-语义学方法，从仫佬族传说“白马娘娘”中提炼文化符号构建IP设计符号库，并运用潘诺夫斯基的三层次图像学分析，探索少数民族神话符号向IP形象转化的新路径。总体而言，现有文献表明，从非遗符号中提取原型意象，通过符号学分析与当代设计手法进行重组，是当前面向非物质文化遗产的IP设计的主要路径。然而，现有研究多为案例驱动，对基础理论框架的探讨不足，尤其缺乏多模态传播的系统性研究。

符号学与视觉传播的设计理论基础。符号学理论为理解和设计文化符号提供了重要框架。索绪尔的经典能指-所指模型认为，符号由外部形式（能指）和内部意义（所指）构成，二者的结合构成了符号的完整含义^[3]。在设计实践中，符号的提取和应用相当于设计师选择、组织和转化视觉元素的过程，使受众能够清晰把握预期信息和情感。卡西尔曾指出，“人是符号动物”，文化创作与传播依赖于符号思维^[4]。因此，长期积淀的传统纹样和图腾已成为承载特定内涵的符号。视觉传播关注通过视觉符号系统传达意义和审美价值；在非遗符号的现代重构中，设计师需要平衡“形式”与“意义”，即外在形式美与内在文化意蕴。近期研究提出了符号转化的具体方法：张雨婷等（2024）认为，传统纹样设计的创新可从三个角度展开——构成要素的提取、价值内涵的阐释、设计应用的创新，从而实现传统符号纹样向当代设计的转化。这包括：首先分析传统符号的基本元素和形式法则；其次在设计过程中挖掘并表达其文化价值；第三结合新媒体与应用场景，赋予传统符号当代活力与产业价值^[5]。余桂淘及其同事对黔江陶器文化基因的研究同样表明，文创设计可采用减法和概括、写实简化以及夸张强调等技艺，对传统器物特征进行艺术加工，创造出兼具民族特色又时尚的元素。总之，符号学为传统符号的提取与阐释提供了理论支持，而视觉传播则为符号重构和审美呈现提供了方法支持。二者结合，能够构建一个指导非遗符号IP设计的理论框架，既忠实于文化内涵，又满足

contemporary aesthetic and multimodal communication requirements.

3. Theoretical Framework Construction

This paper proposes a multimodal IP design framework for ICH symbols comprising three core stages: symbol extraction, visual translation, and multimodal dissemination. Grounded in semiotics and informed by visual communication methods, the framework is intended to guide the systematic transformation of ICH symbols from traditional contexts into contemporary IP forms. First, in the symbol extraction stage, ICH symbols are decoded from the perspectives of signifier and signified; their historical origins, symbolic meanings, and aesthetic characteristics are analyzed to distill typical forms, motifs, color schemes, and formal principles (e.g., symmetry, balance, proportion, rhythm). The underlying cultural values and emotional connotations are further excavated to ensure design materials that are accurate and culturally substantive^[6].

Building on this foundation, visual translation reshapes symbol images through techniques such as reduction, simplification, and exaggeration so that they preserve cultural connotations while meeting contemporary aesthetic and application needs; for example, the extraction of ICH image elements based on visual recognition and generative design highlights the feasibility and effectiveness of these methods^[7]. Multimodal dissemination then extends the finalized IP forms across print, digital, and spatial media, while endowing them with narrative backgrounds and personae to form a cross-media communication matrix that broadens audience reach and cultural impact—an approach already evidenced in applications of digital art and generative AI to ICH design and communication^[8]. Throughout dissemination, authenticity must be maintained to avoid meaning drift caused by over-commercialization. In sum, symbol extraction serves as the foundation, visual translation as the core, and multimodal dissemination as the safeguard; together they constitute a complete pathway for ICH-symbol IP design and provide the theoretical basis for the subsequent case analysis of southeastern Chongqing earthenware.

4. Case Study: IP Design Transformation of Symbols in Southeastern Chongqing Earthenware

Southeastern Chongqing earthenware—an outstanding representative of traditional hand-made pottery in the Wuling Mountain area (inhabited largely by Tujia and Miao peoples)—has a transmission history of over a thousand years. Its production technique (the pottery-making technique of Shijituo in Zhuoshui, Qianjiang District) has been inscribed on the Representative Items List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Chongqing Municipality^[9]. Using locally specific clay and white sandstone as raw materials, artisans combine hand modeling and wheel throwing, followed by natural drying, glazing, and firing in wood-burning kilns, thereby preserving a complete workflow of distinctive traditional methods^[9]. This ICH item is renowned for its simple forms, light texture, and practical beauty, crystallizing the life wisdom and aesthetic ideals of Tujia ancestors.

4.1. Analysis of Symbolic Features

Southeastern Chongqing earthenware contains abundant symbolic elements and formal language. The following analysis considers vessel form, motifs, color, and craftsmanship.

4.1.1. Formal language

Most earthenware pieces are everyday utilitarian vessels (jars, urns, vats, pots, bowls, etc.), with forms that balance utility and aesthetics. Common types feature broad shoulders, a globular belly, a constricted mouth, and a small base; this profile—tapered at top and bottom with a full midsection—facilitates water storage and stable placement in mountainous environments. Artisans emphasize harmonious proportions; in many traditional pieces, height-to-width and mouth-to-belly

当代审美及多模态传播需求。

3. 理论框架构建

本文提出了一个面向非遗符号的多模态IP设计框架，包含三个核心阶段：符号提取、视觉转译和多模态传播。该框架根植于符号学，并借鉴视觉传播方法，旨在引导非遗符号从传统语境向当代IP形态的系统性转化。首先，在符号提取阶段，从能指和所指的角度解码非遗符号；分析其历史渊源、象征意义和审美特征，以提炼典型形态、纹样、色彩方案及形式原则（如对称、平衡、比例、节奏）。进一步挖掘其背后的文化价值与情感内涵，确保设计素材准确且具有文化深度^[6]。

在此基础上，视觉转译通过简化、夸张等技法重塑符号图像，使其在保留文化内涵的同时满足当代审美与应用需求；例如，基于视觉识别和生成式设计提取非遗图像元素，凸显了这些方法的可行性与有效性^[7]。多模态传播则将最终成型的IP形态延伸至印刷、数字和空间媒介，并赋予其叙事背景和角色身份，形成跨媒介传播矩阵，扩大受众覆盖与文化影响力——这一方法已在数字艺术与生成式AI应用于非遗设计与传播的案例中得到验证^[8]。在整个传播过程中，必须保持真实性，避免过度商业化导致意义偏差。总之，符号提取是基础，视觉转译是核心，多模态传播是保障；三者共同构成非遗符号IP设计的完整路径，并为后续渝东南土陶的案例分

4. 案例研究：渝东南土陶符号的IP设计转化

渝东南土陶——武陵山区（主要聚居着土家族和苗族）传统手工陶器的杰出代表——已有上千年的传承历史。其制作技艺（黔江区濯水石鸡坨土陶制作技艺）已列入重庆市非物质文化遗产代表性项目名录^[9]。工匠们以当地特有的粘土和白砂岩为原料，结合手塑与轮制，再经自然干燥、施釉、柴窑烧制，保存了完整而独特的传统工艺流程^[9]。这一非遗项目以其造型古朴、胎体轻薄、实用美观而闻名，凝聚着土家族先民的生活智慧与审美理想。

4.1. 符号特征分析

渝东南土陶蕴含着丰富的符号元素和形式语言。以下从器形、纹样、色彩和工艺四个方面进行分析。

4.1.1. 形式语言

大多数陶器是日常实用器皿（罐、瓮、缸、壶、碗等），其形态兼顾实用与美学。常见类型具有宽肩、鼓腹、敛口和小底的特点；这种上窄下宽、中部饱满的轮廓，便于储水并在山地环境中稳定放置。工匠注重和谐比例；在许多传统作品中，高宽比和口腹比

ratios approximate the golden ratio of 0.618, which is believed to impart a natural sense of harmony^[10]. The vessel body often presents graceful curves: in side view a symmetrical “S”-shaped streamline, and in plan view concentric circles, producing rhythmic line combinations. Overall, the forms are plain yet dignified—hefty yet elegant—reflecting the Tujia aesthetic of “unity of heaven and humanity”: honoring material truth and function while seeking consonance with the natural environment.

4.1.2. Decorative motifs

The surface ornament of these vessels is among their most symbolically meaningful elements, condensing emblematic meanings of ethnic culture. Based on survey and synthesis, common Shijituo motifs may be broadly grouped as follows: (1) totemic motifs, such as the Tujia white-tiger totem and solar-deity totem, simplified and applied to vessel surfaces to signify protection and blessing; (2) emblematic/diagrammatic motifs, including the “Four Spirits” (Azure Dragon, White Tiger, Vermilion Bird, and Black Tortoise) and traditional geometric signs such as the cross, the swastika, and broken-line patterns, symbolizing the four quarters of the cosmos and auspicious eternity; (3) auspicious motifs that use figurative images to convey specific meanings—for example, bats signifying fu (good fortune), gourds signifying fu-lu (fortune and emolument), and dragons signifying propitiousness—thus integrating auspicious culture into decoration; (4) plant motifs—such as pine, bamboo, and plum, or the “Four Gentlemen” (plum, orchid, bamboo, chrysanthemum)—to symbolize noble character and refined taste. These motifs are rendered by carving, appliqué, and painting, transforming reverence for nature and aspirations for a good life into direct visual symbols. Layout emphasizes symmetry and filled compositions—rugged yet delicate—exhibiting a strong ethnic artistic style.

4.1.3. Color composition

The color scheme is dominated by natural clay hues and oxidized glazes, yielding an overall palette that is understated and calm. Because local clay fires to gray-black or earth-red tones, the ware carries an unadorned, earthy quality. In traditional practice, some pieces receive partial application of an iron-based bluish-green glaze (“half green glaze”), producing a contrast between gray-green underglaze and brown-yellow overglaze. This partial-glazing technique preserves the rough clay texture while adding a touch of green at the rim or inner wall, enhancing both utility and beauty. In addition, some craft pieces are painted on the biscuit with concise black-red-white patterns, set against the clay body for stronger decorative effect. In sum, the palette is modest rather than flamboyant, with restrained glaze accents against natural clay, embodying an aesthetic of returning to simplicity—consistent with Tujia values that esteem nature and gravitas.

4.1.4. Craft and formal details

In terms of making, Southeastern Chongqing earthenware integrates hand modeling with wheel throwing, yielding forms that combine the expressive quality of hand shaping with the symmetry and regularity of wheel production. As noted in the introduction to the 8th China Intangible Cultural Heritage Expo, “hand modeling is combined with wheel-thrown firing, with the ‘chicken’ of Shijituo as a primary form, producing various folk animal-shaped craft pieces ...”. Certain special vessel types (e.g., pieces named after “chicken” in Shijituo ware) employ sculptural techniques to add animal attachments, heightening three-dimensional sculptural effect. Local artisans are adept at modeling small animals as handles or spouts on jars and pots—for example, chicken-headed ewers, dragon-headed pots, and toad cups—subtly fusing utilitarian vessels with animal imagery to convey auspicious wishes. Such detailing confers a distinctive regional cultural character, making the ware not only everyday utensils but also artworks that carry stories and emotion.

To facilitate an overview of the key design points for Southeastern Chongqing earthenware, **Table 1** summarizes the preceding analysis in a four-column structure—“Dimension–Features–Cultural Connotations–Design Implications.” Drawing on four dimensions—form (broad shoulders, globular belly, constricted mouth), motifs (white tiger, bagua trigrams, bat, geometric patterns), color (gray-black, earth-red, partial green glaze), and craft (hand modeling combined with wheel throwing)—the table distills core cues related to function and aesthetics and offers actionable guidance for

接近黄金比例0.618，被认为能赋予一种自然的和谐感^[10]。器身常呈现优美的曲线：侧视呈对称的“S”形流线，俯视呈同心圆，产生富有节奏的线条组合。整体造型朴素而庄重——厚重而不失优雅，反映了土家族“天人合一”的审美：尊重材质真实与功能，同时追求与自然环境的协调。

4.1.2. 装饰纹样

这些器物的表面装饰是其最具象征意义的元素之一，浓缩了民族文化的标志性含义。根据调查与综合，常见的石鸡坨纹样可大致归为以下几类：（1）图腾纹样，如土家族的白虎图腾和太阳神图腾，经简化后应用于器物表面，象征庇护与祝福；（2）象征性/图示纹样，包括“四灵”（青龙、白虎、朱雀、玄武）以及传统几何符号如十字纹、万字纹和折线纹，象征宇宙四方与吉祥永恒；（3）吉祥纹样，用具象图像传达特定含义——例如蝙蝠纹寓意福，葫芦纹寓意福禄，龙纹寓意吉祥——从而将吉祥文化融入装饰；（4）植物纹样——如松竹梅或“四君子”（梅、兰、竹、菊）——以象征高尚品格与雅致情趣。这些纹样通过雕刻、贴塑和彩绘等技法呈现，将对自然的敬畏与对美好生活的向往转化为直观的视觉符号。布局强调对称与满构图——粗犷中见细腻——展现出浓郁的民族艺术风格。

4.1.3. 色彩构成

色彩方案以天然陶土色调和氧化釉色为主导，整体色调淡雅沉静。当地陶土烧制成灰黑或土红色调，赋予器物质朴的泥土质感。传统工艺中，部分器物会局部施以铁系蓝绿釉（半绿釉），形成灰绿地釉与棕黄釉面之间的对比。这种半釉技法保留了粗糙的陶土肌理，同时在口沿或内壁增添一抹绿色，兼顾实用性与美感。此外，有些工艺作品在素坯上绘制简洁的黑白红线纹，与胎体形成更强的装饰效果。总之，色彩基调含蓄而非张扬，以克制的釉彩点缀天然陶胎，体现了返璞归真的美学——这与土家族崇尚自然、庄重的价值观一脉相承。

4.1.4. 工艺与造型细节

在制作方面，渝东南土陶融合了手塑与轮制，产生兼具手塑表现力与轮制对称规整性的形态。正如第八届中国非物质文化遗产博览会介绍中所指出的，“手塑与轮制烧制相结合，以石鸡坨‘鸡’为主要形式，制作出各种民间动物造型工艺制品……”。某些特殊器型（如石鸡坨陶器中的“鸡”命名器物）采用雕塑技法添加动物附件，增强了三维雕塑效果。当地工匠善于在罐、壶上塑造小动物作为把手或壶嘴——例如鸡首壶、龙首壶和蟾蜍杯——巧妙地将实用器皿与动物意象融合，以传达吉祥寓意。这种细节处理赋予了独特的地域文化特征，使陶器不仅是日常用具，更是承载故事与情感的艺术品。

为便于概览渝东南土陶的关键设计要点，**表1**以四列结构——“维度-特征-文化内涵-设计启示”总结前述分析。基于形态（宽肩、鼓腹、敛口）、纹样（白虎、八卦、蝙蝠、几何图案）、色彩（灰黑、土红、局部绿釉）和工艺（手塑结合轮制）四个维度，该表提炼了与功能和审美相关的核心线索，并提供了可操作的指导，以便

design translation, enabling rapid alignment with IP characters, identity marks, and derivative development (**Table 1**).

Table 1. Overview of Symbolic Features of Southeastern Chongqing Earthenware and Key Points for Design Translation

Dimension	Features	Cultural Connotations	Design Implications
Form	Broad shoulders; globular belly; constricted mouth	Stability; storage utility	Can be abstracted into a geometric silhouette
Motifs	White tiger; <i>bagua</i> trigrams; bat; geometric patterns	Apotropaic (warding off evil); blessing; auspiciousness	Develop as graphic motif “seeds”
Color Palette	Gray-black; earth-red; partial green glaze (<i>ban-qing</i>)	Plainness; veneration of nature	Emphasize a “natural + subtle accents” scheme
Craft	Combination of hand modeling and wheel throwing	Craftsmanship ethos; regional character	Suited to anthropomorphized character design

4.2. IP Design Transformation

Building on the foregoing symbolic features of Southeastern Chongqing earthenware, this study applies the proposed framework to explore pathways for its IP-oriented design.

4.2.1. Symbol Extraction

Identify core symbolic elements and cultural themes from the earthenware. For example, abstract the typical broad-shouldered, globular-belly vessel into a concise geometric silhouette; distill representative motifs from the pottery (e.g., white tiger, *bagua* trigrams, bat) as design seeds and summarize their auspicious, benedictive meanings^[6]. In terms of cultural connotations, concepts embedded in the ware—such as “reverence for nature,” “craftsman spirit,” and a “plain-living aesthetics”—should likewise be extracted, aligning with recent research on the “output of value connotations” in ICH symbol studies^[11].

4.2.2. Visual Translation

When deploying these elements in concrete IP forms, both personified and symbolized approaches may be adopted. For instance, one may design a character whose body contour derives from the earthenware silhouette (“Tutaowa”), with an exaggerated Tujia white-tiger motif integrated into the headpiece, garment patterns sourced from typical pottery motifs, and a colorway featuring clay brown as the main tone accented by touches of bluish green—conveying an image that is at once rustic and lively. Alternatively, one may create a mascot or logo based on a pottery vessel, highly abstracting a jar together with a coiling snake motif to form a fluid line-based icon that communicates the vessel’s typological features while implying protective serpent totemism. Such methods accord with visual communication practices of “simplification–abstraction–recomposition”^[12]. During design development, exaggeration can be used to reinforce the ware’s sturdy, affable form (e.g., emphasizing the rounded “belly” to enhance cuteness and approachability), while simplification can reduce complex ornament so that the IP remains legible at small sizes^[7]. Iterative refinement ensures the IP form expresses the distinctive symbolic aesthetics of Southeastern Chongqing earthenware, aligns with contemporary tastes, and appeals to younger audiences. For clarity, a process diagram is provided to visualize the traditional-to-modern design pipeline—“Original Artifact – Symbol Extraction – Visual Translation” (**Figure 1**).

设计转化 快速对接IP角色、标识和衍生开发（**表1**）

表1. 渝东南土陶符号特征及设计转化关键点概述

维度	特征	文化内涵	设计启示
Form	宽肩；鼓腹；敛口	稳定性；储藏功能	可抽象为几何轮廓
纹样	白虎；八卦卦象；蝙蝠；几何图案	辟邪；祝福；吉祥	发展为图形元素“种子”
色彩调色板	灰黑；土红；局部绿釉（半青）	质朴；崇敬自然	强调一种“自然+微妙点缀”方案
工艺	手塑与轮制结合	工匠精神；地域特色	适合拟人化角色设计

4.2. IP设计转化

基于前述渝东南土陶的符号特征，本研究运用所提出的框架，探索其面向IP的设计转化路径。

4.2.1. 符号提取

从陶器中识别核心符号元素与文化主题。例如，将典型的广肩圆腹器皿抽象为简洁的几何轮廓；从陶器纹样（如白虎、八卦、蝙蝠）中提炼代表性图案作为设计种子，并总结其吉祥、祝福的寓意^[6]。在文化内涵方面，陶器所蕴含的“敬畏自然”、“工匠精神”及“朴素生活美学”等理念也应被提取，这与近期非遗符号研究中关于“价值内涵输出”的探讨相呼应^[11]。

4.2.2. 视觉转译

在将这些元素具体化为知识产权形式时，可以采用拟人化和符号化两种方法。例如，设计一个身体轮廓源自陶器轮廓（“土陶娃”）的角色，头饰融入夸张的土家族白虎纹样，服装图案取材于典型陶器纹饰，配色以陶土棕为主调，辅以蓝绿色点缀，传达出既质朴又活泼的形象。或者，基于陶器容器设计吉祥物或标志，将罐子与盘蛇纹样高度抽象，形成流畅的线条化图标，传达容器的类型特征，同时暗示守护性的蛇图腾。这些方法符合“简化-抽象-重组”的视觉传播实践^[12]。在设计开发中，可通过夸张手法强化陶器敦厚可亲的形态（例如，强调圆润的“腹部”以增强可爱度和亲和力），同时简化复杂装饰，使知识产权在小尺寸下保持清晰可辨^[7]。迭代优化确保知识产权形式表达渝东南土陶独特的符号美学，符合当代审美，并吸引年轻受众。为清晰起见，提供了流程示意图来展示传统到现代的设计路径——“原始器物-符号提取-视觉转化”（**图1**）。

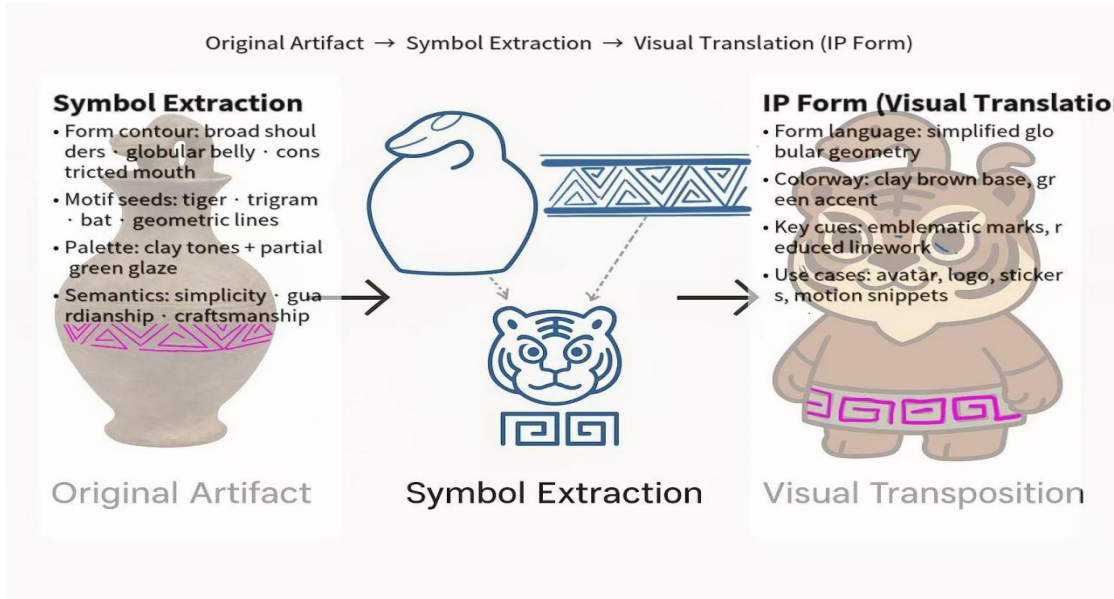


Figure 1. Schematic of IP Design Transformation for Southeastern Chongqing Earthenware

4.2.3. Multimodal Applications

Apply the completed IP image of Southeastern Chongqing earthenware across diverse media and settings to effectively tell the “earthenware IP” story. On one hand, endow the IP with a narrative background—for example, cast it as a pottery spirit from Tujia folklore tasked with transmitting ceramic culture—and embody traits such as diligence, simplicity, and guardianship of the homeland; such narrative framing strengthens the IP’s emotional appeal^[13]. On the other hand, develop a series of derivatives and communication carriers: produce animated shorts or sticker packs themed on the earthenware IP, weaving the making process and cultural lore into the storyline^[14]; design cultural-creative products such as figurines, plush toys, stationery, and apparel to meet the preferences of different consumer segments^[15]; install IP sculptures or photo spots at production-area attractions and transform traditional workshops into immersive experience spaces so that visitors can interact and take photos with the IP, thereby enhancing tourism appeal^[16]. Through online–offline, cross-media integration, increase the exposure and influence of the earthenware IP, promote market conversion of local ICH products, and support rural revitalization and cultural-industry development^[17]. It is essential, however, to uphold respect for ICH in commercial applications—for instance, by inviting heritage bearers to serve as advisors or supervisors—so as to keep the IP aligned with the cultural core of earthenware and prevent symbolic distortion^[18]. Only in this way can the IP of Southeastern Chongqing earthenware truly integrate cultural and economic value and become a successful case of traditional pottery flourishing in the new era.

The above analysis shows that, as a Southwest ethnic ICH symbol, Southeastern Chongqing earthenware provides valuable material for IP design through its rich formal symbols and cultural connotations. Under the guidance of semiotics, systematic extraction and translation, supplemented by multimodal creative communication, can transform this ancient ICH symbol into a vibrant modern IP image^[6]. This case also offers a reference pathway for the IP-ization of other ICH symbols. Numerous ICH elements in Southwest China—such as embroidery patterns, instrumental music and traditional opera, and myths and legends—can follow this approach to achieve creative transformation and innovative development^[19].

5. Conclusion

This study examines multimodal IP design for ICH symbols, integrates semiotics and visual communication theory, and proposes a systematic framework of symbol extraction, visual translation, and multimodal dissemination, validated through the case of Southeastern Chongqing earthenware. The findings show that ICH symbols embody rich formal beauty and

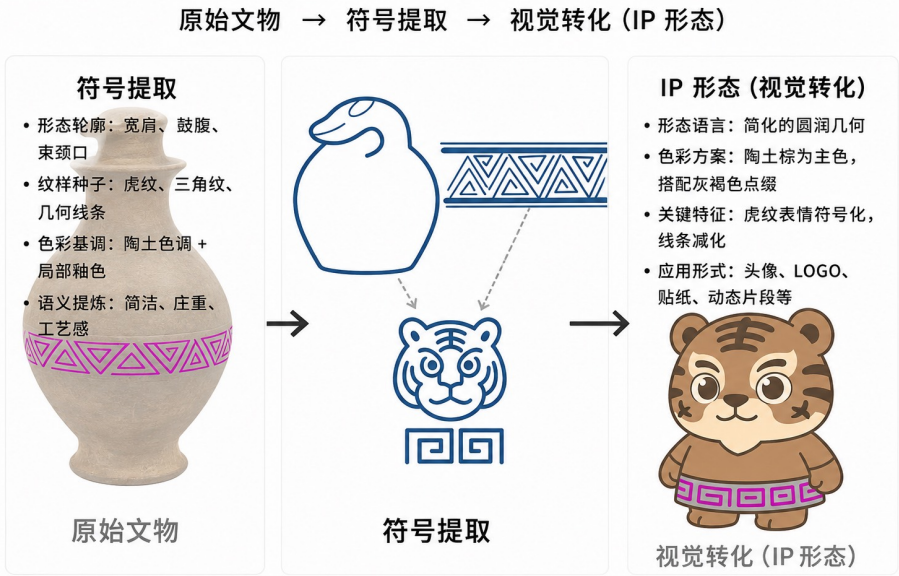


图1. 渝东南土陶IP设计转化示意图

4.2.3. 多模态应用

将渝东南土陶的完整知识产权形象应用于多样化的媒体和场景，有效讲述“土陶知识产权”故事。一方面，赋予知识产权叙事背景——例如，将其塑造成土家族传说中负责传播陶瓷文化的陶灵，体现勤劳、质朴、守护家园等特质；这种叙事框架增强了知识产权的感染力^[13]。另一方面，开发一系列衍生品和传播载体：制作以土陶知识产权为主题的动画短片或贴纸包，将制作工艺和文化故事融入剧情^[14]；设计手办、毛绒玩具、文具、服装等文创产品，满足不同消费群体的需求^[15]；在产区景点设置知识产权雕塑或拍照点，将传统工坊改造为沉浸式体验空间，供游客互动合影，提升旅游吸引力^[16]。通过线上线下跨媒体整合，增加土陶知识产权的曝光度和影响力，促进当地非物质文化遗产产品的市场转化，支持乡村振兴和文化产业发展^[17]。然而，在商业应用中必须尊重非物质文化遗产——例如，邀请传承人担任顾问或监督，以确保知识产权与土陶文化内核一致，避免符号扭曲^[18]。唯有如此，渝东南土陶的知识产权才能真正融合文化与经济价值，成为传统陶器在新时代蓬勃发展的成功案例。

上述分析表明，作为西南少数民族非物质文化遗产符号，渝东南土陶通过其丰富的形式符号和文化内涵，为IP设计提供了宝贵素材。在符号学指导下，通过系统提取与转译，辅以多模态创意传播，可将这一古老的非遗符号转化为鲜活的现代IP形象^[6]。该案例也为其他非遗符号的IP化提供了参考路径。中国西南地区众多非遗元素——如刺绣纹样、器乐戏曲、神话传说等——均可借鉴此路径实现创造性转化与创新性发展^[19]。

5. 结论

本研究探讨了非遗符号的多模态IP设计，整合了符号学与视觉传播理论，提出了符号提取、视觉转译和多模态传播的系统框架，并通过渝东南土陶案例进行验证。研究发现，非遗符号蕴含丰富的形式美与

cultural connotations, offering distinctive resources for IP design; semiotic decoding helps grasp cultural essences, visual communication provides pathways for modern reconfiguration, and multimodal strategies secure broad application and impact^[14]. The framework enables designers to achieve creative transformation while respecting tradition, allowing ICH symbols to retain their cultural roots and acquire contemporary vitality.

The theoretical model of IP-ization for Southwest ethnic ICH proposed here has implications for research and practice: (1) emphasize deep cultural interpretation grounded in semiotics to avoid superficial collage; (2) foreground cross-disciplinary design methods, integrating digital modeling, AR, and related technologies to expand modes of expression; and (3) consider the value of ICH IP from the perspectives of cultural soft power and national image building, thereby supporting the dissemination of Chinese aesthetics and international cultural exchange. It should be noted that this study focuses on a single case (Southeastern Chongqing earthenware); other ethnic ICH symbols and multimodal dimensions—such as sound, haptics, and interaction—require further exploration. Future work should curb over-commercialization while strengthening the protection of heritage bearers and techniques to maintain a dynamic balance between transmission and innovation, enabling ICH IP design to drive the sustainable development of national culture^[18].

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文化内涵，为IP设计提供了独特资源；符号解码有助于把握文化精髓，视觉传播为现代重构提供了路径，多模态策略确保了广泛的应用和影响^[14]。该框架使设计师能够在尊重传统的同时实现创造性转化，让非遗符号既保留文化根基又获得当代活力。

本文提出的西南少数民族非物质文化遗产IP化的理论模型对研究与实践具有启示：(1) 强调基于符号学的深度文化阐释，避免浅层拼贴；(2) 突出跨学科设计方法，整合数字建模、增强现实及相关技术以拓展表达模式；(3) 从文化软实力和国家形象塑造角度考量非遗IP的价值，从而支持中国美学的传播与国际文化交流。需要指出的是，本研究聚焦于单一案例（渝东南土陶）；其他民族非遗符号及多模态维度——如声音、触觉和交互——有待进一步探索。未来工作应遏制过度商业化，同时加强对传承人与技艺的保护，以维持传承与创新之间的动态平衡，使非遗IP设计推动民族文化的可持续发展^[18]。

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披露声明

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